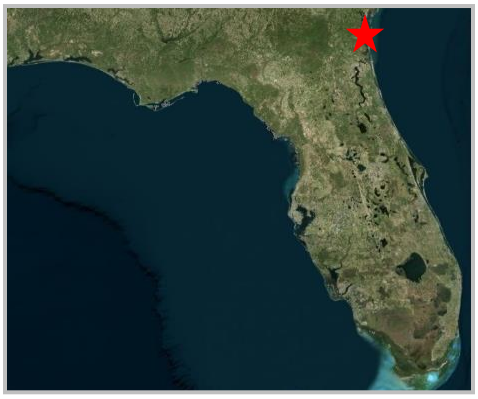
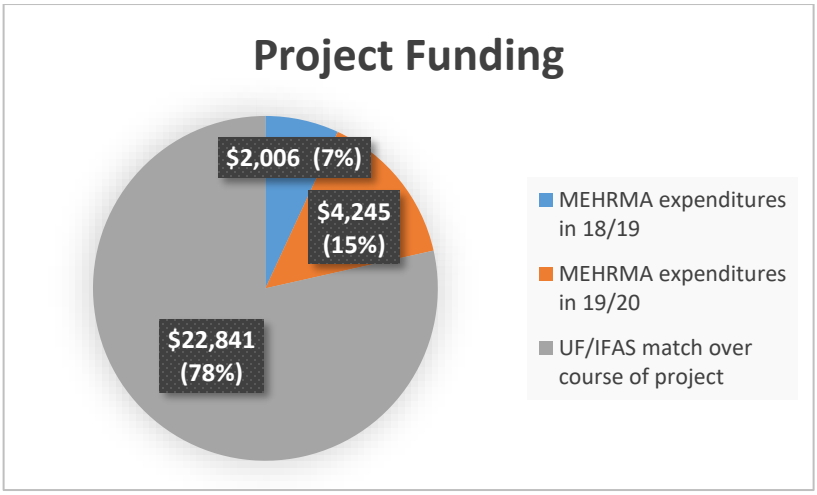
Goffinsville Park Living Shoreline, Goffinsville, Nassau County, FL

FY 19/20





Project Description

Goffinsville Park is a popular park managed by Nassau County, within the Nassau River – St. Johns River Marshes Aquatic Preserve. The Park includes a playground, picnic area, restrooms, fishing pier, and public boat ramp. A living shoreline was completed in 2016 along approximately 200' of shoreline on the western edge of the park. This project built on the success of the 2016 efforts by installing multiple non-plastic oyster restoration materials to serve as a wave break in front of the seawall, extending the existing living shoreline. This arrangement allows for side-by-side comparison of multiple oyster restoration materials, including CORE modules, Reefballs, and Reef Prisms. The project is intended to enhance estuarine habitat, improve water quality, and reduce erosion while engaging the public. Volunteers and citizen scientists were involved in the project via the Florida Master Naturalist Program, IFAS Extension opportunities, and the Florida Master Gardener Program. The Park now serves as a demonstration site for homeowners to physically view available material options when planning to install a living shoreline along their own waterfront property. High-quality educational signs displayed above the demonstration area outline the benefits of living shorelines and the specific materials utilized at the site.



Figure 1: Volunteers deploy oyster CORE modules along the shoreline at Goffinsville Park in 2019.

UF/IFAS Extension with Nassau County took the lead on this project, working closely with the UF Whitney Laboratory for Marine Bioscience. FWC supported the effort through the purchase of oyster CORE modules, supplies to construct reef prisms, design and purchase of educational signs, as well as field support for monitoring and installation. In FY 18/19, $2,006 were spent on the project to purchase supplies. The remaining $4,245 was expended in FY 19/20 to cover additional

supplies and signs. UF/IFAS Extension provided $22,841 of in-kind match through staff time (480 hours) and volunteer assistance (320 hours).

Benefits

- Attenuate waves and boat wakes
- Provide oyster reef and salt marsh habitat
- Provide example of a "hybrid" living shoreline at a highly visible public park
- Provide insight regarding the performance of new oyster restoration materials
- Provide nursery and foraging habitat for a variety of wildlife including juvenile fish, invertebrates, oysters, and wading birds.
- Establish a living shoreline demonstration site in Nassau County

MESS Strategic Plan Elements Supported

Goal 1, Objective 1.1, Strategic Action 1.1.1

Identify and develop restoration projects in marine and estuarine habitats (e.g., mangrove, sea grass, salt marsh, oyster reef, coral reef) on publicly owned state lands including those found on conservation lands acquired through non-regulatory means.

Goal 1, Objective 1.2, Strategic Action 1.2.2

Develop success criteria and assess project results.

Goal 2, Objective 2.2, Strategic Action 2.2.2

Develop and implement monitoring or sampling protocols to assess the effects conservation activities.

Goal 4, Objective 4.2, Strategic Action 4.2.1

Develop and disseminate restoration project results and techniques as outreach products (e.g., reports, presentations, publications).

Acreage restored by habitat type (footprint)

Total- 0.13 acres oyster and saltmarsh:

- Breakwater/oyster habitat- 0.04 acre
- *Spartina* alterniflora- 0.09 acre (targeted)

Acreage affected: 17,234 acres (Nassau Sound – Fort George Inlet Frontal HUC-12)



Figure 2: Educational signs overlook the demonstration area and highlight the benefits of living shorelines.



Figure 3: Project partners and volunteers monitor CORE modules at Goffinsville Park in August 2020.